THE NEPAL DISCOURSE
APRIL 2026

Opening Plenary: Human Development, AI and Next Generation Leadership

April 25 | 09:30 - 10:45 AM | Askwith

Anup Kaphle
Group Editorial Director
Kantipur Media Group

Dr. Sameer Maskey
CEO
Fusemachines Inc

Dr. Peter Q. Blair
Associate Professor
Harvard University

TBA

THE NEPAL DISCOURSE
APRIL 2026

From BPO to IPO: Leveraging AI for Startup Acceleration and Economic Leapfrogging

April 25 | 10:45 - 12:00 PM | Larsen

Prasanna Dhungel
Co-Founder
GrowByData

Bal Krishna Joshi
Founder
Xuno

Karvika Thapa
CEO
Kimbu Tech

Rumee Singh | Moderator
CEO & Co-Founder
Rumsan

THE NEPAL DISCOURSE
APRIL 2026

Mobility and Connectivity

April 25 | 2:45 - 4:00 PM | Askwith

David Sislen
Division Director
World Bank

Micheal P. Foley
CEO
Ncell

TBA

Bibek Raj Kandel | M.
Practitioner
Asia Global Institue

THE NEPAL DISCOURSE
APRIL 2026

Future Proofing the Curriculum: Integrating AI Literacy and Skills for Next-Gen Employment

April 25 | 10:45-12:00| Askwith

Sulav Budathoki
Chairman, CEO
ING Group

Dr. William Wisser
Director
Teaching Learning Lab, HGSE

Rupa Laxmi Shah
Director
MIT RAISE

Swastika Shrestha
CEO
Teach for Nepal

Dr. Arun Joshi
CEO
Leadership Academy Nepal

THE NEPAL DISCOURSE
APRIL 2026

Diaspora, Migration, and Representation

April 26 | 1:00 - 2:15 PM | MIT

Mahendra Pandey
Director
Humanity United

Dr. Bishnu Maya Pariyar
Co-Founder
NJ Speaks

Samjhana Gurung Shrestha
Program Lead
Nepali Class Boston

Dhadiram Bhandari
Consul General of Nepal
New York Office

THE NEPAL DISCOURSE
APRIL 2026

Financing the Future: Blended Capital and Policy Pathways for Climate Resilience

April 25 | 10:45 - 12:00 PM | Longfellow

Arun Banskota
CEO
BluEarth Renewables

David Sislen
Division Director
World Bank

Manoj Poudel
CEO
Aadhyanta Fund

Amelia Vanderlaan
Former US Diplomat
Harvard Kennedy School

THE NEPAL DISCOURSE
APRIL 2026

From Prediction to Wisdom: Human Decision-Making in the AI Era

April 25 | 1:30 - 2:45 PM | Larsen

Lino Ahlering
Fmr Managing Director
Daraz Nepal

Dr. Ashish Luitel
Adjunct Professor
University of Cumberland

Dr. Sameer Maskey
CEO
Fusemachines Inc

Rupa Laxmi Shah | Moderator
Director
MIT RAISE

THE NEPAL DISCOURSE
APRIL 2026

Nepal and Emerging Industries

April 26 | 9:45 - 11:00 AM | MIT

Dr. Biswash Gauchan
Executive Director
IIDS

Nishchal Banskota
Founder
Nepal Tea Collective

Subarna Basnet
Director
MIT International Design Center

Shuvangi Rana | M.
Program Manager
MIT KSC

THE NEPAL DISCOURSE
APRIL 2026

Designing Nepal's AI Skills Strategy

April 26 | 11:00 - 12:15 PM | MIT (45-230)

Dr. Sanjay Manandhar
CEO
Zifino

Biswas Dhakal
Chariman
F1Soft

Rumee Singh
CEO
Rumsan

Swastika Shrestha
CEO
Teach For Nepal

Dipta Shah | Moderator
Co-Founder
VikasaTech

THE NEPAL DISCOURSE
APRIL 2026

The Trust Deficit: Leading Institutions in the Age of Digital Mobilization and Dissent

April 26 | 9:45 - 11:00 PM | MIT (45-102)

Ashish Luitel
Team Lead
N-able

TBA

Sharad Raj Aran
Charge d' Affaires a.i
The Embassy of Nepal in Washington, D.C.

Hitesh Hathi | Moderator
Executive Director
Harvard South Asia Institute

THE NEPAL DISCOURSE
APRIL 2026

The Cultural Playbook: Building Community and Leadership Through Art & Culture

April 26 | 1:30 - 2:45 PM | Larsen

Kiran Bhakta Joshi
Founder/CEO
Incessant Rain Studios

Sophia L Pandé
writer, art-historian,
and filmmaker

TBA

Anup Kaphle
Group Editorial Director
Kantipur Media Group

THE NEPAL DISCOURSE
APRIL 2026

Creating Nepal's Next Billion-Dollar Company for our Human Capital

April 26 | 2:25 - 3:15 PM | MIT

Rahul Agrawal
Chariman
Siddhartha Bank

Sambhav Swar Sirohiya
Managing Director
Kantipur Media Group

Biswas Dhakal
Chariman
F1Soft

Dipta Shah | Moderator
Co-Founder
VikasaTech

THE NEPAL DISCOURSE
APRIL 2026

Next Gen Leadership: Navigating Multipolarity and Strategic Autonomy

April 26 | 9:45 - 11:00 AM | MIT (45-230)

Nishcal Rai
Member of Parliament
Government of Nepal

Raksha Bam
Youth Activist

Pukar Bam
Member of Parliament
Government of Nepal

Semanta Dahal
Partner, Abhinawa Law Chambers
Chair, Purak Asia

Ang Sonam Sherpa | M.
Senior Analyst
Cornerstone Research

THE NEPAL DISCOURSE
APRIL 2026

Remittance Plus Economy

April 26 | 1:00 - 2:25 PM | MIT

Bhawani Rana
President(2017 - 2020)
FNCCI

Hem Raj Dhakal
Founder and Managing Director
IME Group

Rahul Agrawal
Chairman
Siddhartha Bank

Subash Sharma
CEO
F1Soft/eSewa

Prof. Tarun Khanna | M.
Jorge Paulo Lemann Professor
Harvard Business School